nullah to their platoon fieldwork was extremely steep; therefore, the Sikhs would be able to mow down the enemy with their Lee Enfield .303 rifles.

Elements of the attacking Chinese force that had bypassed the Assam Rifles post had started to engage Joginder Singh's platoon on the IB Ridge by 5 a.m. The Sikh position dominated the approaches, and the Chinese had no choice but to climb up a nullah to try and close the gap. Heavy mortars engaged the first wave of the Chinese, forcing them to scatter and pull back. For the Sikhs, the main problem was the lack of ammunition. Joginder Singh on the field line once again asked the Delta Company commander, Kaushik, to try and restock his position. By then Tongpeng-la was also in contact with the Chinese, and Kaushik asked Joginder Singh to fall back to the company location.

However, Joginder Singh preferred to fight from his position on the IB Ridge. He told Kaushik his men would hold their position come what may. In reality, despite having broken up the first Chinese attack, Joginder had lost half his platoon owing to the sheer volume of Chinese fire. The Chinese regrouped and launched a second attack, this time from the right flank, which was also stopped. However, by then only a handful of men were still alive to give fight to the Chinese, who were trying hard to hold their own line and put in yet another attack.

Kaushik asked Joginder if he should go 'red over red' which would mean asking the artillery to open fire on 11 Platoon's own position. Without any hesitation, Joginder said, 'Haanji, saab'. Just then the Chinese found and cut off the communication line, leaving the platoon isolated. Joginder Singh had already been shot in the thigh and was bleeding profusely. His platoon now had barely any ammunition. Just as he shouted to the few survivors to take cover, Gosal's guns opened up, devastating the confined area. The Sikhs huddled in their trenches, waiting. Joginder Singh told the surviving men to fix bayonets and they now waited for the Chinese to make their way through the black, blood-splattered rocks towards them. On his command, a final charge was put in but the Chinese automatic weapons that were highly effective at close range cut down most of the men. The wounded Joginder Singh, weak from the loss of blood, was overpowered and captured by the Chinese. While their attention was on the JCO, who would not stop struggling, three surviving members of the platoon managed to slip away. They rejoined the battalion and gave a detailed account of Joginder Singh's last battle.